Welding Tips

A good way to test welding technique is to examine a weld's appearance after it has cooled and the slag has been removed. Then, better welding can be learned by adjusting your weld technique to remedy any problems found.

NOTICE: TIG welding is a complicated process, requiring experience and skill to achieve successful results. Training beyond the scope of this manual is required to TIG weld properly.

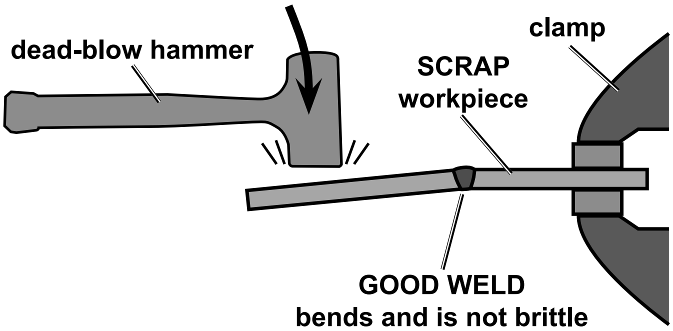
After practice welding a couple of welding beads, STOP and examine your weld using the following guidelines.

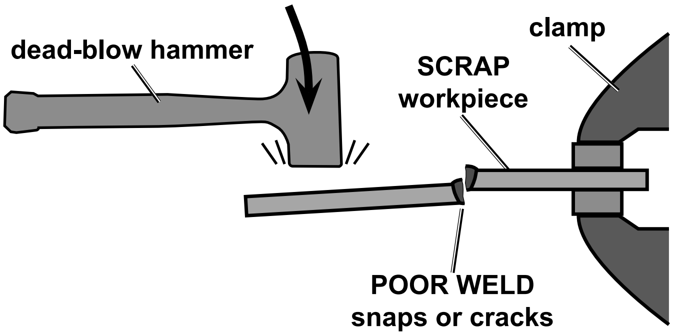
Strike Test

A test weld on a PIECE OF SCRAP can be tested by using the following procedure. WEAR ANSI-APPROVED SAFETY GOGGLES DURING THIS PROCEDURE.

CAUTION! **This test WILL damage the weld it is performed on. This test is ONLY an indicator of weld technique and is not intended to test working welds.**

1. After two scraps have been welded together and the weld has cooled, clamp one scrap in a sturdy vise.
2. Stay clear from underneath while you strike the opposite scrap with a heavy hammer, preferably a dead-blow hammer.
3. A **GOOD WELD** will deform but not break, as shown on top.
   A **POOR WELD** will be brittle and snap at the weld, as shown on bottom.





Cleaning the Weld

⚠WARNING

TO PREVENT SERIOUS INJURY:
Continue to wear ANSI-approved safety goggles and protective wear when cleaning a weld.
Sparks or chips may fly when cleaning.

1. A weld from flux-cored wire welding or stick welding will be covered by slag. Use a chipping hammer to knock this off. **Be careful not to damage the weld or base material.**
2. Use a wire brush to further clean the weld or use an angle grinder (sold separately) to shape the weld.